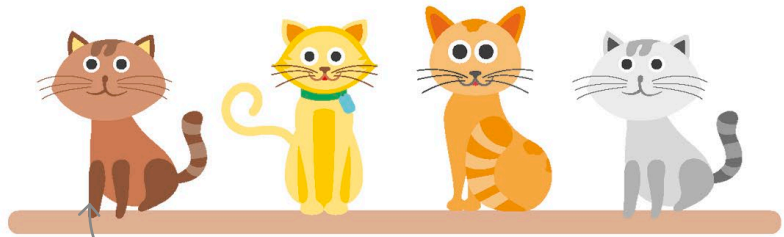


CSS syntax

CSS can be split into two parts: selectors and declaration blocks. Selectors identify which elements on the webpage are going to be affected by styling. Declaration blocks, the section of code inside the curly braces, contain the styling. Let's say you're working with a group of cats. To ensure they don't all look the same, they need to be divided into groups. CSS provides several ways to do this.



Cats can be identified by name, breed, and colour.

△ Choosing selectors

The right method for selecting elements depends on how common a style is, how detailed it needs to be, and what other styles are being used.



Ids

Every cat has a unique name, and similarly, every HTML element can be given a unique id. This allows developers to have complete control over the styling of a single element. However, styling elements one at a time takes longer.



Elements

Just as cats can be selected by breed, the easiest way to select elements is to use the type of the tag. HTML examples include body, paragraph, table, and image tags. It's a quick and easy method, but not very flexible.

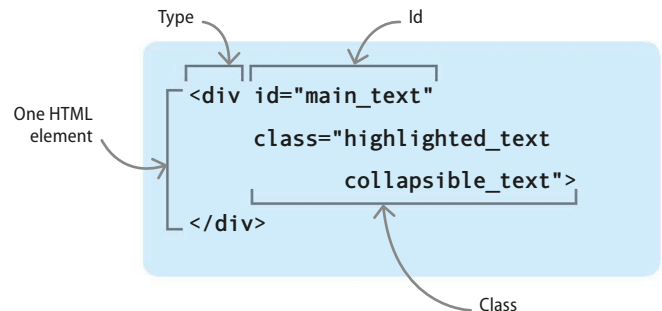


Classes

A class can be given to multiple elements. Since classes are user-defined, an unlimited variety can be created, and a single element can be given multiple classes. Examples of feline classes are "indoor cats" or "white cats".

Which selector wins?

What if an element is selected multiple times and inherits conflicting styles? Text can't be both red and blue and a picture can't simultaneously be aligned to the right and to the left. To determine what an element's final styling is, CSS has a complicated order of precedence. A good rule of thumb is that the most specific selector wins over more general selectors. Inline styling is considered more specific than an id, which wins over a class, which in turn wins over an element. However, there's still lots of room for confusion.



◁ Inline styling

In general, inline styling makes code cluttered and inefficient. However, it's the most specific selector, so it's still used from time to time in modern web development.